Validation Purpose & Scope Standard

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Canonical Definition

Validation Purpose & Scope Standard (VPSS) defines the governance conditions under which the purpose, boundaries, depth, applicability, limitations, and intended use of validation are formally established before validation criteria, methodology, evidence assessment, execution, determination, state, or reliance are governed.

Canonical Definition Extension

A precisely established Validation Object does not by itself determine what validation must accomplish.

The purpose of validation must be known.

The scope of validation must be bounded.

The required depth must be proportionate to the intended use and governance significance of the validation.

The applicability of the validation must be established.

Its limitations must remain explicit.

Validation Purpose & Scope Standard therefore governs the transformation of a validation requirement into a formally defined **Validation Mandate.**

The standard establishes the governance conditions necessary to determine:

- why validation is being performed,
- what validation is expected to establish,
- which dimensions of the Validation Object are included,
- which dimensions are excluded,
- how deeply the object must be examined,
- where the resulting validation may legitimately apply,
- which intended uses the validation is expected to support,
- and which limitations constrain interpretation or reliance.

VPSS does not determine whether the Validation Object is valid.

VPSS does not define the criteria against which validity will be determined.

VPSS does not prescribe the technical validation method.

VPSS determines what the validation is required to accomplish and establishes the governed perimeter within which the resulting validation may legitimately operate.

Core Question

Why is validation required, what must it cover, to what depth must it proceed, and within which limits may its results apply?

Purpose

The purpose of Validation Purpose & Scope Standard is to ensure that every validation process begins with an explicit reason, defined governance perimeter, proportionate depth, identifiable applicability, and documented limitations.

The standard prevents validation from becoming:

- purposeless,
- unnecessarily broad,
- insufficiently narrow,
- disproportionate to its intended use,
- interpreted beyond its actual coverage,
- or relied upon for purposes for which it was never designed.

Governance Objective

VPSS establishes the validation-purpose and validation-scope governance layer required to convert an established Validation Object into a governed validation mandate.

The standard seeks to ensure that:

- validation has an explicit purpose,
- the intended use of validation is known,
- validation scope is bounded,
- inclusions and exclusions are explicit,
- validation depth is proportionate,
- applicability conditions are established,
- limitations remain visible,
- scope changes remain governable,
- and subsequent validation activities remain aligned with the original validation mandate.

Operational Role

Validation Purpose & Scope Standard serves as the **mandate-definition stage of the VALIDOS® validation governance lifecycle.**

It receives an established Validation Object and determines the governed purpose and perimeter within which that object will be validated.

VPSS creates the governance bridge between:

What is being validated?

and:

Against what conditions should validity be determined?

The resulting validation mandate provides the reference required for subsequent validation criteria, methodology, evidence, execution, determination, state, and reliance governance.

Governance Scope

Validation Purpose & Scope Standard governs:

- validation purpose,
- validation objectives,
- intended validation use,
- validation scope,
- scope inclusion,
- scope exclusion,
- validation depth,
- validation proportionality,
- validation applicability,
- applicability conditions,
- validation limitations,
- scope assumptions,
- scope changes,
- and validation-mandate continuity.

Validation Purpose & Scope Governance Model

VPSS establishes the following governance progression:

Validation Object → Validation Purpose → Validation Scope → Validation Depth → Validation Applicability → Validation Limitations → Governed Validation Mandate

This progression establishes what validation must accomplish before the criteria and methodology used to perform validation are determined.

Validation Purpose Requirements

Every governed validation should have an identifiable purpose.

The purpose should establish why validation is required and what governance need the validation is intended to address.

Validation purposes may include:

- establishing suitability for operational use,
- supporting a deployment decision,
- evaluating a claim,
- supporting regulatory or compliance requirements,
- assessing a model or system,
- establishing confidence before reliance,
- evaluating a changed object,
- supporting an assurance process,
- assessing readiness for a defined use,
- or another legitimate validation objective.

The purpose must be sufficiently precise to guide subsequent validation governance.

Validation Scope Requirements

Validation scope establishes the governed perimeter of the validation activity.

The scope should identify, where applicable:

- which characteristics of the Validation Object are included,
- which functions are included,
- which behaviors are included,
- which operating conditions are included,
- which environments are included,
- which time periods are included,
- which use cases are included,
- which populations or users are included,

- which dependencies are included,
- and which materially relevant dimensions are explicitly excluded.

The scope of validation must remain distinguishable from the boundary of the Validation Object.

Object boundary determines what the object is.

Validation scope determines which aspects of that object the validation will examine.

Validation Depth

Not every Validation Object requires the same depth of validation.

Validation depth should reflect the degree of examination necessary to satisfy the validation purpose.

Relevant considerations may include:

- intended use,
- operational significance,
- complexity,
- uncertainty,
- potential consequences,
- dependency exposure,
- governance requirements,
- regulatory requirements,
- reversibility,
- and risk.

Validation depth should be proportionate rather than automatically maximal.

Insufficient depth may produce unjustified confidence.

Excessive depth may consume resources without materially improving the validation determination.

VPSS therefore governs the methodological justification for the required depth of validation.

Validation Applicability

A validation result does not automatically apply to every use, environment, decision, deployment, or operational context involving the Validation Object.

VPSS establishes the conditions under which the validation is intended to be applicable.

Applicability may be limited by:

- use case,
- operational environment,
- jurisdiction,
- population,
- deployment condition,
- system configuration,
- time period,
- dependency condition,
- risk level,
- decision type,
- or another materially relevant factor.

The resulting validation must not be interpreted as broader than its governed applicability.

Validation Limitations

Every validation may contain limitations.

Limitations should be identified before or during validation whenever they become known.

Relevant limitations may include:

- excluded object characteristics,
- unavailable information,
- restricted environments,
- incomplete access,
- limited evidence,
- temporal restrictions,
- methodological constraints,
- unavailable populations,
- untested operational conditions,
- unresolved dependencies,
- or other factors limiting interpretation.

Limitations do not automatically invalidate a validation.

They define the boundaries within which the validation result may be interpreted and relied upon.

Scope Change Governance

Validation purpose and scope may change during the validation lifecycle.

A material change may occur when:

- the validation objective changes,
- additional object characteristics are introduced,

- exclusions are removed,
- new use cases are added,
- validation depth is materially increased or reduced,
- applicability is expanded,
- limitations materially change,
- or the intended reliance changes.

Material scope change should not occur silently.

It should be documented, assessed, and propagated to subsequent validation governance activities where necessary.

A material scope expansion may require reconsideration of criteria, methods, evidence, sources, execution, or previous determinations.

Purpose–Scope Alignment

The validation scope must be capable of answering the validation purpose.

A validation may be technically well executed while remaining methodologically inadequate if its scope cannot support its stated purpose.

VPSS therefore requires alignment between:

Purpose → Scope → Depth → Applicability → Limitations

Where the scope is insufficient to answer the stated purpose, validation should not proceed under the assumption that the purpose can be satisfied.

Governance Boundary

Validation Purpose & Scope Standard begins when a sufficiently established Validation Object requires formal validation and the reason, extent, depth, applicability, and limitations of that validation must be determined.

It ends when a sufficiently defined Validation Mandate exists to support the establishment of validation criteria.

VPSS does not determine:

- the identity or structural boundary of the Validation Object,
- the substantive criteria determining validity,
- validation methodology,
- technical testing procedures,
- evidence fitness,
- source reliability,
- validation execution,
- validation determination,
- validation state,
- reliance authorization,

- or revalidation outcomes.

These responsibilities belong to other VALIDOS® Parent Standards or applicable complementary governance frameworks.

Minimum Governance Requirements

A conforming implementation of VPSS should establish:

- 1. an identifiable validation purpose,
- 2. a defined validation objective,
- 3. a bounded validation scope,
- 4. explicit material inclusions and exclusions,
- 5. a justified validation depth,
- 6. defined applicability conditions,
- 7. documented material limitations,
- 8. and a persistent Validation Mandate connecting subsequent validation activities to the approved purpose and scope.

Governance Outputs

VPSS may produce:

- Validation Purpose Statement,
- Validation Objective Record,
- Validation Scope Definition,
- Validation Inclusion Record,
- Validation Exclusion Record,
- Validation Depth Determination,
- Validation Applicability Profile,
- Validation Limitation Record,
- Scope Change Record,
- Purpose–Scope Alignment Determination,
- Validation Mandate.

These outputs establish the governed mandate required for subsequent VALIDOS® validation governance.

Operational Applications

Validation Purpose & Scope Standard may be applied across:

- artificial intelligence,
- autonomous systems,
- machine learning models,
- data and analytics,
- predictions and simulations,
- enterprise systems,
- financial services,

- healthcare,
- industrial operations,
- regulatory compliance,
- critical infrastructure,
- digital assets,
- digital identities,
- operational governance,
- public-sector systems,
- multi-system environments,
- and any governed environment requiring formal validation.

Relationship to Other OOF Architectures

Validation Purpose & Scope Standard interoperates with:

- **GOA™**
- **OBIDENITY®**
- **INTEGROS®**
- **ORA™**
- **AGA™**
- **AIG®**
- **CLIA®**
- **MGIA™**
- **ASGA™**
- **RIS™**

by providing the canonical validation-governance methodology for defining why validation is required, what the validation must cover, how deeply it must proceed, where its results may legitimately apply, and which limitations constrain interpretation and reliance.

VPSS does not replace governance scope, operational boundaries, risk governance, authority governance, or other responsibilities established by complementary OOF® architectures.

It translates relevant governed requirements into a validation-specific purpose and scope while retaining responsibility specifically for **validation-purpose and validation-scope governance.**

Foundational Principle

Validation can support only the purpose and scope it was designed to examine.

Canonical Closing Statement

Validation Purpose & Scope Standard establishes the canonical validation-governance framework for determining why validation is required and defining the governed perimeter within which it must operate. By governing purpose, objectives, scope, depth, applicability, limitations, proportionality, and scope change, VPSS ensures that subsequent validation activities remain aligned with an explicit mandate and that validation determinations are not interpreted or relied upon beyond the conditions they were designed to examine.

Validation Purpose & Scope Standard

Architecture: VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture
Category: AI & Interpretation · **Subcategory:** Validation Governance

Canonical Definition: Validation Purpose & Scope Standard (VPSS)
defines the governance conditions under which the purpose, boundaries, depth, applicability, limitations, and intended use of validation are formally established before validation criteria, methodology, evidence assessment, execution, determination, state, or reliance are governed.

Governed Space: Validation Purpose & Scope

Validation can support only the purpose and scope it was designed to examine.

→ View Standard

Module Architecture

→ Validation Purpose Identification Module (VPIM)

→ Validation Scope Definition Module (VSCDM)

→ Validation Depth Calibration Module (VDCM)

→ Validation Applicability Mapping Module (VAMM)

→ Validation Limitation Governance Module (VLGM)

Parent Resources

→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map

→ VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index

→ VALIDOS® — Four-Layer Validation Protocol™

Standards Compatibility

→ Validation Object Standard
Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

→ Validation Criteria Standard
Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

→ Validation Method Standard
Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

→ Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard
Operational compatibility within the governed validation lifecycle.

Related Documents

→ About Validation Purpose & Scope Standard

→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer

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Canonical Source

https://originopenfoundation.org/